Which way is up?

Grey: the top of each map. Colour: where true north points on the map, from the best fit.

Ptolemy



north up

Peutinger



turned 17° anticlockwise

al-Idrisi



south at the top

Carta Pisana



turned 9° anticlockwise

Hereford



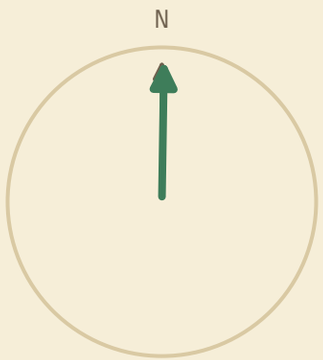
turned 88° anticlockwise

Gough



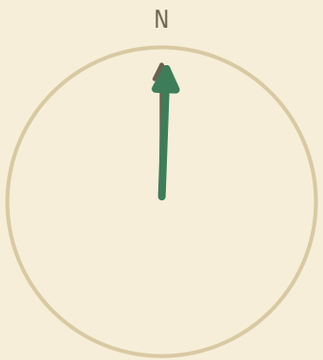
turned 95° anticlockwise

Saxton



turned 1° clockwise

Ino



turned 2° clockwise

Data: control points from eight published studies by the author (Zenodo, CC BY 4.0); Natural Earth (public domain)

maps.tristanhotham.com/map-accuracy